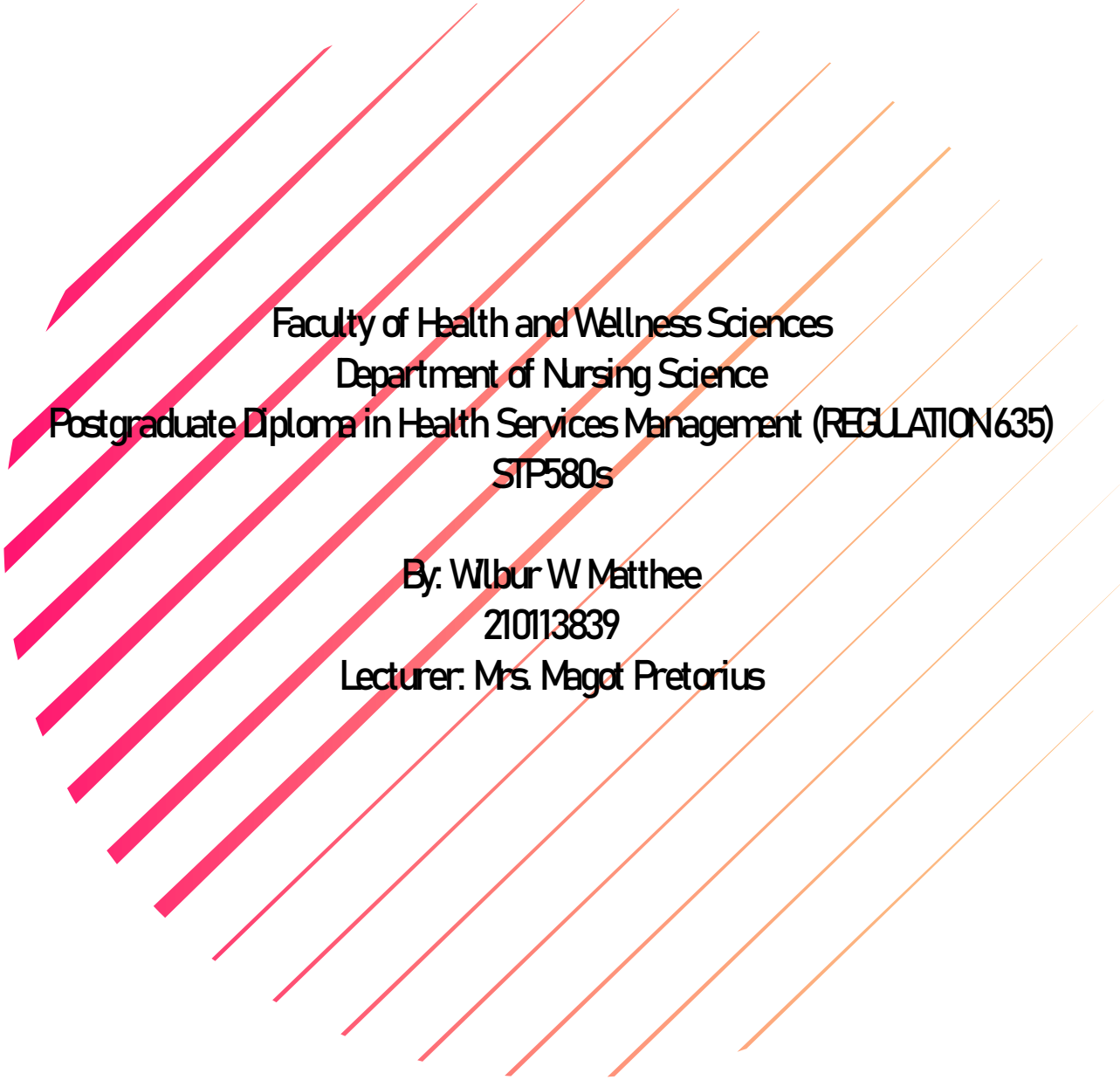


Strategic Thinking and Planning



Faculty of Health and Wellness Sciences
Department of Nursing Science
Postgraduate Diploma in Health Services Management (REGULATION 635)
STP580s

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FACULTY OF HEALTH AND WELLNESS SCIENCES

DEPARTMENT OF NURSING SCIENCE

Addendum 4 - Assignment cover sheet

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1. Introduction

I am assigned a task/assignment for strategic thinking and planning in which I have to demonstrate the ability to direct and coordinate the nursing activities toward achieving relevant strategic and operational goals. Additionally, demonstrate a coherent and in-depth understanding of principles of business management in the private or public health sector. And finally, I have to apply knowledge of the characteristics of a positive practice environment and organizational culture for health professionals to ensure a conducive setting for the achievement of the goals of the healthcare facility to ensure quality care for all the clients/patients (stakeholders) in health care facilities.

2. Overview of the strategic human resource process

According to Muller, Bezuidenhout, and Jooste, (2011: 259-262), human resource planning is a process of making provision for the movement of people into, in, and out of the organization. The authors tell us about the purpose of this planning process allowing the effective allocation of resources where they are needed, to achieve the goals of the organization. Whereas, Booyens and Bezuidenhout (2014: 22-23) write it is a process involving a set of procedures to make decisions regarding an organization's long-term goals and strategies. Setting up a committee tasked with. It is the process of linking the human resource function with the strategic objective of the organization to improve performance. Strategic human resource planning is the process of analyzing and identifying the need for and the availability of human resources so that the organization can meet its objectives.

Below I discuss the five stages of strategic human resource planning according to Walker (1980: 55-67)

2.1.1 Investigating

The first step of the human resource planning process has to do with identifying the key business issues. Muller, Bezuidenhout, and Jooste, (2011: 259), tell us about a process called environmental scanning, this process allows human resource planners to identify and anticipate potential sources of problems, threats, and opportunities which drives an organization's strategic thinking and provides a better understanding of how human resource decisions are made. The authors mention that this process enables organizations with planning for problems arising from both stable and dynamic conditions. The authors add in their conclusion that the organizational structure should be examined given future developments, whether top to bottom positions are appropriate for the organization tomorrow and what functional areas or activities can expect to undergo severe growth or contraction?

In conclusion, investigating the human resource process is a continuous process of planning to achieve the optimal use of the organization's most valuable assets.

2.1.2 Forecasting

Muller, Bezuidenhout, and Jooste, (2011: 259- 261), categorize this phase into two parts by developing a clear understanding of how information is gathered. Firstly, affects the demands of the organization, and secondly an accurate picture of the current supply available inside the organization.

The authors state that many forecasting methods can be used to determine the organization's demand for human resources. Furthermore, the type of forecasting method applied will depend on the timeframe and type of organization. Two types of

forecasting can be applied by line managers to determine the organization's demand for human resource

- Judgmental forecast: this type of forecast mainly involves the use of human judgment rather than manipulation of numbers. When using this method line managers must make certain assumptions about the organization and its environment, keeping in mind the organization's strategic plan involving new products or expanding markets.

Common judgmental methods of predicting human resource demands:

- Managerial estimates
 - The Delphi technique
 - The Norman Group technique
- Statistical projections: the workforce required are based on organizational factors. The authors make the example of a hospital making use of a statistical method using the data of patient load to determine the number of nurses needed at some point in time this approach is easily applied in an area with small population growth.

Common statistical methods used in demand forecasting:

- Trend analysis
- Ratio analysis
- Regression analysis

In conclusion, the method used will primarily depend on the type of environment if the organization is stable, you would make use of the statistical approach whereas an environment that experiences explosive growth and change would rely on the judgmental approach.

2.1.3 Action planning

According to Booyens and Bezuidenhout (2014: 31), the third stage in the human resource management process is action planning whose objective is to formulate detailed plans for realizing divisional objectives. Operational level staff will give their inputs regarding their objectives and personal needs for their staff to the head of their divisions. To ensure that these inputs regarding operational level objectives and needs are met, human resource planners or coordinators will plan ongoing workgroups with divisional and departmental heads to ensure their active involvement to meet those objectives and needs. During these workgroups, human resource planners will provide guidelines such as set dates for the submission of completed documents. Based on these submission dates, dates will be set for meetings with peers and top management.

The authors continue by writing that the results of the environmental analysis external and internal will determine the strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats of human resources. Human resource issues will be identified and taken into consideration when planning. Human resource planners will develop a schedule of personnel required in consultation with the divisions to carry out the respective plans. The completed action plans with financial estimates will be incorporated into the corporate and organizational planning of the whole organization. This can only be done once the divisional plan has been approved by top management.

2.1.4 Implementing

Booyens & Bezuidenhout (2014: 33) state, that implementation is the fourth stage of the human resource planning process, this is the process where the divisional human resource action plan is put into action. It is achieved through practical application of the programs for human resource management, such as recruiting, selection, appointment, and programs for individual performance appraisal and development. Human resource management will aim to ensure the commitment and cooperation of those managers responsible for implementing the planning.

The authors remind us with the implementation of human resource plans comes change which may be introduced at different levels. They identify a challenge for managers at all levels which is the effective introduction and management of change for those caught

up in the situation. Line managers are supported by the human resource department to implement the plans which they have designed. A fundamental role that human resource management play is to counter resistance to change and maintain good relationships between and among managers and the staff by supporting and motivating personnel. During the period of change, the line managers are responsible for maintaining good industrial relations and ensuring good staff relationships and communication. Implementation will follow the human resource plan. Progress, phasing, and finance will be monitored, evaluated, and controlled.

Implementation of a human resource plan for nursing:

According to Booyens and Bezuidenhout (2014: 33-34), the biggest establishment of a healthcare organization would be the nursing component, making it the costliest category of staff and a very complex component in the planning, provision, maintenance, and development of staff. With the management of the nursing function, a heavy load of work is normally generated, and for this reason, it is essential to involve the operational healthcare managers in the process and to support them.

The authors state that coordinating and controlling the implementation of the nursing human resource plan would be very effective. The committee members should represent all levels of management so that decisions can easily be taken. The aim of the committee is the overall control and coordination of the functions related to the establishment and maintenance of nursing posts.

2.1.5 Monitoring

Booyens & Bezuidenhout (2014: 34), states that this is the final stage in the human resource planning process where we will monitor and evaluate the progress made in the implementation of the detailed human resource plan, and incorporate activities such as recruiting, training and development. During the monitoring, stage results are evaluated against the objectives set, and the information is then fed back into the system, so that in case of deviations, contingency plans may be devised.

Elements of a formal evaluation and review procedure:

The authors state that the formal evaluation and review procedure should involve the evaluation of the human resource programming activities and the correction of any deviations that are found.

Such a review according to the authors should include;

- ❖ Actual versus planned staffing requirements;
- ❖ Productivity levels versus established goals;
- ❖ Actual personnel flows (turnover, absenteeism, and promotions) versus acceptable rates;
- ❖ Operational personnel programs versus planned programs;
- ❖ Labour and program cost versus budgeted amounts; and
- ❖ A comparison of program results (benefits or failures) with program cost.

In conclusion, Booyens & Bezuidenhout (2014: 34), write for effective monitoring, evaluation, and feedback on results we require an evidence-based, disciplined approach, and a well-planned comprehensive computerized information system.

2.2 Reflect on your role as a nurse manager in the unit to ensure that all nursing activities towards the relevant strategic goals have been met.

The emergency department of any healthcare facility can be considered the face of the organization; thus the team must know their triple aims which will ensure that we reach the collective strategic goal of our organization which is to achieve excellence in service.

The first aim would be to improve the quality of care provided, by decreasing the length of stay within the unit, we don't just aim to decrease the length of stay but aim to make the visit as convenient as possible by being visible and keeping patients updated by

providing information continuously throughout the stay. We adopted an open-door policy for patients to allow them to enquire about their progress in the system.

The second aim would be to improve patient outcomes, by educating them on the correct levels of care and having referral systems in place to ensure they receive the correct level of care required.

Finally reducing the cost of care which rides on the back of the second aim educating them on the correct level of care to improve patient outcomes by reducing expenditure and allowing the population entry to the correct level of care.

2.3 Discuss the strategic levels which need to be considered when you are planning to develop a strategic plan for a health service. Include in your discussion the comprehensive functions of Human Resource Management

2.3.1 Corporate or organizational

Admin, n.d. states, that this component prepares statements of mission, vision, policy, strategy, and goals, within which the division prepares its plans.

Top management where human resources are responsible for liaison with divisions

2.3.2 Divisional, departmental, or unit

Study.com, states that this component entails the plan of action employed by the healthcare service to achieve its set of objectives within a set timeframe. Even though most plans laid out by the healthcare service are independent of time and the availability of resources within a specific period and that is why every factor plays a vital role in the planning process.

Senior management.

2.3.3 Administrative and logistical services

MBA Knowledge Base, 2010. state that this is a unified, comprehensive, and integrated planning process to achieve competitive advantage by anticipating future demand and managing the resources of the entire supply chain it is carried out within the framework of the overall corporate or organizational goals and plan.

Human resources provide support services to managers at all levels

2.3.4 Operational

www.skedulo.com, n.d.state that this component is very critical it is the planning, organizing, and supervising of internal processes to keep an organisation running smoothly.

3. Business Principles

3.1 Do an in-depth Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, and Threats (SWOT) analysis of the health service where you are working

One of the strongest components would be that within our institution we have very skilled staff with very great potential who care and deliver high standards of quality care. The problem we have or weaknesses are staff shortage this problem causes burnout and leads to absenteeism as 3 professional nurses, 3 enrolled nurses and 2 enrolled nursing assistants should man an entire emergency unit of 140 patients at handover per shift.

An opportunity exists for the advancement of technology to ease the burden of care and aid the overwhelming patient workload, this can be achieved by developing technologies that will assist the faster processing administration of care such as advancements in the triage system.

Our institution's location is a constant safety threat, the community we serve has a direct reflection on the institution and safety is always a problem even though we have security violence still tends to break out

Table 1.1 SWOT analysis

Within the organization	Positive factors	Negative factors	1. Strengths 2. Weaknesses 3. Opportunities 4. Threats
	1. Skilled Staff	2. Staff Shortages Absenteeism	
External to organization	3. Technology	4. Safety	

3.2 Discuss in detail how you would do the identification of a need in both public and private sectors for the approval of health facilities. Use the generic planning process (CIDB 2010) to assist you.

3.2.1 Needs (What infrastructure or capacity s required?)

We require an improved triage system to decongest the emergency center. We have the necessary infrastructure but not the necessary staff complement to accommodate this improvement

3.2.2 Supply (What infrastructure or capacity does the organization have?)

In our institution, we have an extra room or two that has the necessary tools and equipment to accommodate patients.

3.2.3 Compare the aforementioned

With an extra nurse and doctor screening green and yellow patients. Having the necessary infrastructure but not having the capacity needs to be addressed.

3.2.4 Identify the gaps

The current state is the congested emergency center. The aim is to improve the triage system to decongest the emergency center. The gap would be not having the capacity of staff to aid in the decongestion of the emergency center.

3.2.5 Plan

To allocate one nurse and doctor to only focus on green and yellow presentations by having a meeting with both the operational manager and consultants to make extra staff available on their shifts who can rotate every shift to man the green and yellow patients.

3.3 Describe financial management

The responsibility of making sure that the business makes the best use of its financial resources (Booyens & Bezuidenhout 2014: 121). There are basic activities that need to be understood and in place that guides each step in the utilization of money which in turn ensure the effective use of money toward the realization of organizational goals. (Booyens & Bezuidenhout 2014: 121)

3.3.1 Financial accountability

Financial accountability equates to answerability, liability, and the expectation of account-giving. Booyens & Bezuidenhout (2014: 121) state that being financially accountable means providing records, feedback, and explanations of your actions and

decisions in terms of the money entrusted to you. Meaning that the money entrusted to you was used for what it was intended and the funds were not misused leading to damage to the integrity of the institution. In the event, that the person to whom funds were entrusted does not uphold the delegated responsibilities then some kind of sanction or penalty is justifiable.

3.3.2 Internal control

Booyens & Bezuidenhout (2014: 121) state internal control within an organization is facilitated and regulated by utilizing financial policies and procedures which highlight how to follow the processes of procurement, payment of goods, and services rendered. All of these actions should be clearly and accurately recorded to ensure transparency.

3.3.3 Record keeping

To keep all communication in terms of financial matters, financial documents and transactions filed, so that a trail of evidence can be provided for accounting records several aspects to be considered during the process of record-keeping (Booyens & Bezuidenhout 2014: 121- 125).

- A functional filing system: as soon as financial documents come in it should dictate who will receive the documents, where they are kept until they can be given attention, and where and how the documents should be filed.
- Reliable accounting records: computerized systems are available to ease the process and facilitate the electronic storage of documents.
- Managerial accounting: relates to the provision of financial information required to manage the organization.
- Fixed and variable costs: fixed cost is those that do not change whereas variable cost is those that vary in proportion to changes in the workload.
- Ratio analysis: an indication of the organization's performance and state of financial affairs.

- Break-even analysis: a technique used to find the specific volume at which a program or service neither makes nor loses money.

3.3.4 Budgeting

An instrument to measure whether an organization is managing the money they have responsibly, a planning and control tool that enables the administration of funds Booyens & Bezuidenhout (2014: 127).

3.3.5 Cash flow management

Borad, 2018 describes cash flow management as following a process by which an organization maintains control over the inflow and outflow of funds. The fundamental goal of cash flow management is to ensure that the incoming flow of funds is always greater than the outgoing so that the business sits on a surplus.

3.3.6 Financial reporting

This reporting illustrates the organization's strengths and weaknesses, providing evidence upon which decisions can be based. Valid and accurate financial reporting requires that activities regarding financial accountability, internal control and record-keeping are well entrenched and performed on time Booyens & Bezuidenhout 2014: 134.

3.3.7 Audits

Audits are a critical component of financial accountability it is a process of reviewing documents to establish accuracy and completeness Booyens & Bezuidenhout 2014: 134.

3.4 Reflect on what your role is in all of the above financial management issues

The emergency unit operated at a very fast pace.

This is the reason why we have allocated professional nurses to ensure that ordering takes place and requisitions are filled in as soon as possible not letting work stand over or handing it over to the next shift to ensure the timely completion of work. We have a quota ordering system to ensure that we do not overstock but in the event that we run short on supplies or consumables, we have a disaster room available as our last resort. To ensure the effective utilization of perishable supplies we also work on a first in first out system this system only works well but in order to make sure the system works we have to check the expiry dates of products to make sure that we don't lose supplies to wastage. In the event that supplies are soon to expire, we work in collaboration with our pharmacy to get the supplies out to areas that might be using it more often to prevent wastage.

Another method I used and encourage staff to make use of too is that supplies and equipment should be only used for what it is intended.

4. Quality Control

4.1 Study the Policy on Quality Health Care for South Africa, issued in April 2007 by the Department of Health. Pay particular attention to the policy regarding the following:

4.1.1 Creating an environment in which quality health care will flourish

The policy talks about strengthening the hand of the user by providing them with the required information they need to make an informed choice. To focus on equity of healthcare and vulnerable populations which will be the driving force to improve the quality of care to underserved populations.

By promoting public and private partnerships and the accountability of both sectors for quality improvement through a coordinated effort where the two sectors complement each other.

Finally reducing errors and increasing safety in health care by identifying and reducing errors and focusing on systems of change to reduce injuries and adverse events. An incident reporting system has been developed by the national health system to identify errors and prevent their recurrence.

4.1.2 Building capacity to improve quality

The policy says it can be done by fostering evidence-based practice and innovation to improve the quality of healthcare services delivery of care should be based on sound scientific evidence and continuously introducing innovative, effective healthcare practices and preventative approaches. By adapting organizations for change and keeping up with the rapid pace of change in the science of health care.

Engaging the healthcare workforce changes taking place in healthcare systems and efforts to improve quality opens the possibility of taking on new roles and responsibilities. Healthcare professionals need to be closely involved in working on ways to improve the way they work. It is important that healthcare workers who are strongly dedicated to caring for patients and knowledgeable need to be further developed to improve the quality of care.

The policy also talks about training and professional development because providing quality care to patients requires training skilled health workers and establishing a culture that values lifelong learning and its important role in quality improvement.

Finally, the policy state that investing in information systems that measure quality improvement these systems should be able to guide internal quality improvement efforts, generate data on the individual and institutions' comparative performance to help improve the coordination of care and support continued research and innovation.

4.1.3 Delivering quality care in the public sector

The policy states, that in both the private and public sectors, it is the task of staff to deliver quality care improvements. A quality assurance approach and culture are required for the delivery of health care. In the public sector, action is required at all levels.

To ensure that national standards and guidelines are reflected in service delivery, we require consistent action. The district health system is ideally positioned to facilitate this action because it is close enough to the community to be responsive to their needs and is great for improving the quality of care.

4.1.4 Monitoring standards

The policy talks about ongoing quality monitoring to ensure that health services deliver quality services that patients have the right to receive:

The first would be quality monitoring by users where we use a national complaint procedure the users are entitled to obtain a full explanation and effective remedy for a professional or another fault from a public, private or non-governmental health establishment within the national health system. A patient safety satisfaction survey where the views and experiences of users are used to enable health establishments to assess their progress and compare their performance with services elsewhere.

The second would be quality monitoring through structures of governance: such as the office of standard compliance which will select a standard national of indicators for each level of care to monitor. The provincial inspectorate for health establishments will monitor how health establishments comply with conditions imposed on them relating to the certificate of need process. Hospital board and clinic committees it is expected from every hospital and community to establish a board or committee with members from both the public and management dealing with matters relating to the quality of care provided and whether health right is being upheld the Batho-Pele principles are adhered to in service delivery and collective complaints.

The third would be quality monitoring by the provider of services by making use of a staff satisfaction survey to identify what aspects are negatively impacting the quality of

care being provided. A clinical audit is essential for in-patient care where all health professionals at all levels of care will participate. These clinical audits will allow opportunities that promote education and research aid in developing and implementing clinical guidelines and contribute toward managing resources. Supervisory visits are formal visits that ensure that all aspects of service delivery are addressed and the needs of healthcare workers are met this supervision will include providing support in solving problems and training to help improve performance.

Another aspect would be facility-based quality teams who monitor the quality of service they provide through analyzing the core data they collect on mortality and morbidity data and infectious diseases.

5. As the nurse manager, you are part of a team that needs to look at quality improvement measures in the surgical unit at your institutions. Discuss the principles of the formalized process to assist you and your team in following the correct processes.

5.1.1 The formulation of standards

We would, first of all, make out a written description of the expected level of performance, this written description will define key functions and activities to provide quality services e.g. adequate analgesic management post-operative, and professional nurses will be responsible to drive this initiative of care following surgical intervention. Booyens & Bezuidenhout (2014: 416- 417)

5.1.2 Assessing performance against these standards, also referred to as monitoring and evaluation

For us to monitor and evaluate our formulated standards, we would develop a measuring tool, which will allow us to test and make sure that we comply with the principle of reliability and trustworthiness. The measuring tool used would be

practical to enable easy management. Methods used would be document analysis and auditing, patient satisfaction, and monitoring of negative incidents and clinical events. The data will be collected by a designated professional nurse on each shift. Another method would be using a discharged questionnaire to collect data. Booyens & Bezuidenhout (2014: 417- 419)

5.1.3 The implementation of corrective or remedial action to improve the quality of service delivery

Once the results of monitoring and evaluation are known we can now make the required improvements or corrective action. We can look at issues such as why post-operative analgesia is not given as prescribed by doing audits on patient's records, patient feedback, or whether analgesia has been prescribed and put in place measures to avoid the reoccurrence of inadequate quality of care. Now that the result is known a professional development programme can be developed. Booyens & Bezuidenhout (2014: 420- 427)

5.1.4 A review of the quality improvement process, challenges, value-added and outcomes. During the review process, we will identify and debate those challenges experienced. Did the formulation of new standards make a difference in the quality of care? Booyens & Bezuidenhout (2014: 420)

5.2 Reflect on the following questions using one of the models given previously.

5.2.1 How can quality be assured in health care?

Quality can be assured in health care by appointing the right people for the job. Sending staff for the necessary training in their respective fields and allowing staff to identify gaps in their training or skills.

Another method to assure quality is by means of patient feedback such as patient satisfactory questionnaires this would also be to identify gaps in the services and finding ways to improve on those areas where improvement are required.

5.2.2 How will one know that quality is being assured?

To motivate staff to identify those areas that they feel they require training and to set up those training for them. Making a system of feedback available that is not complicated for patients to utilize and having a system in place to constantly monitor the feedback received for patients.

5.2.3 Who is responsible for quality assurance and control?

Everyone in healthcare is responsible for quality assurance. The quality assurance officer works closely with all departments to ensure that the quality assurance policy are upheld and implemented.

6. Conclusion

Here I have demonstrated the ability to direct and coordinate nursing activities toward achieving relevant strategic and operational goals. The demonstration of an in-depth discussion of business management in both the private and public health sectors. Applied knowledge of the characteristics of a positive practice environment and culture for health professionals to ensure a conducive setting for the achievement of the goals for the health facility.

7. Reflection on Compiling this Portfolio

The compilation of this portfolio required a lot of research and preparation. For some reason, I managed to overlook these activities and just before the due date it was brought to my attention, this would most probably be due to time management and focusing too much on one thing and overlooking others. The first semester was new for everyone as it is a new program approved by the South African Nursing Council and presented by the Cape Peninsula University of Technology. It had quite a few teething problems but we have managed it well besides the work schedules and other factors such as network problems, technical problems, and load-shedding.

Despite all those negative elements mentioned the compilation of this portfolio has equipped me with the necessary skills and knowledge to practice safer, efficiently, and with more confidence. It has also allowed me to allocate the necessary time for my subjects and to start working on my portfolios as soon as they become available to prevent myself from falling into the trap of late submission. I have also come to notice that with early commencement of the portfolio it will allow me to enquire with my lecturer or peers on areas I might find difficult.

The solution is in the name of the subject strategic thinking and planning. I believe I can safely say that I am equipped with the skills to think strategically and plan more efficient.

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